

User Guide

For Students and Instructors

Working languages: Arabic | French | English

Final Year Project - ESIB, Universite Saint-Joseph

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1. First-Time Setup — Get Your API Key

The platform uses Groq to generate speeches and evaluate your performance. Groq is free — you just need your own personal key.

Step 1 — Create a free Groq account

- Go to console.groq.com
- Sign up with your email address (free, no credit card needed)
- Once logged in, click API Keys in the left menu
- Click Create API key, give it a name (e.g. "ETIB"), and copy the key

Your key starts with gsk_ Keep it private — do not share it with anyone. If it leaks, delete it on console.groq.com and create a new one.

Step 2 — Save your key in the platform

- Open the ETIB platform and log in to your account
- Click the gear icon (Settings) in the top navigation bar
- Paste your key in the field that shows gsk_...
- Click Test key — you should see "Key is valid and working"
- Click Save key

Your key is saved in your browser only. No other student or the server can see it. Each student uses their own quota from their own free Groq account.

2. Create an Account and Log In

- Open the platform in your browser
- Click Create an account
- Enter your full name, email, and a password (at least 8 characters)
- Select your role: Student, Instructor, or Coordinator
- Click Create account — you are logged in automatically

Next time, use Sign in with your email and password.

3. Module A — Generate a Training Speech

This is where you create the speech you will interpret. Click Generate speech in the navigation bar.

Basic generation (topic-only)

- Choose the Speech language (the language the speaker will use: AR, FR, or EN)
- Choose the Target language (the language you will interpret into)

- Type a Topic (e.g. "climate change", "digital health", "water scarcity")
- Choose a Domain

Setting	What it does
Speech length	Short (~150 words), Medium (~250), Long (~350)
Difficulty	Beginner, Intermediate, Advanced, Expert
Discourse structure	Argumentative, Narrative, Descriptive, Mixed
Interpretation mode	Consecutive, Simultaneous, Sight translation
Number density	Controls how many figures and statistics appear
Hesitations	Adds natural fillers (euh, um, ah) to the speech
Pressure mode	Speed pressure, topic shifts, cognitive load

- Click **Generate speech**

The speech appears below. A note tells you whether it was grounded in a real UN document.

Document-grounded generation

Upload a PDF, Word, or text file as the source. The platform extracts key content using AI (RAG — Retrieval-Augmented Generation) and builds the speech around it.

- Expand the **Document grounding** section
- Click **Choose file** and upload your document
- Adjust settings as usual, then click **Generate from document**

*Click **Preview retrieved context** to see exactly which passages the AI used from your document before generating.*

UN Library

Click **UN Library** to search real United Nations speeches and documents. When you select one, the generated speech will be grounded in actual UN content and factually verified.

4. Module B — Listen and Study

After generating a speech in Module A, click **Audio & materials** in the navigation bar.

Audio playback

- Choose a voice accent (Lebanese Arabic, Gulf Arabic, Parisian French, etc.)
- Adjust the speech rate if you want it slower or faster for practice
- Click **Generate audio** — the audio player appears
- Listen to the speech as you would in a booth

Pedagogical materials

Click **Generate materials** to get:

Material	Description
Key terms	5 important domain-specific terms from the speech
Thematic summary	A visual tree structure of the main ideas
MCQ	2-3 multiple-choice comprehension questions with answers
Open questions	Discussion questions about the speech content
Trilingual glossary	AR / FR / EN equivalents for the key terms

- Click **Download glossary (DOCX)** to save as a Word file you can edit and study offline

5. Module C — Record Your Interpretation

- Click **Record & transcribe** in the navigation bar
- Select the language of your interpretation (not the source — the language you are speaking)
- Click the record button and start interpreting
- Click **Stop** when you are done
- Click **Transcribe** — takes 5-15 sec with Groq, up to 2 min with the local fallback

The transcript appears with timestamps. For Arabic, the system adds tashkeel (vowel diacritics) reflecting what you actually pronounced — including case-ending errors. Low-confidence words are highlighted and may indicate pronunciation issues.

6. Module D — Get Your Evaluation

Click **Evaluation** in the navigation bar. This module compares your recorded interpretation against the original speech.

Scores (0-100)

Score	What it measures
Overall	Combined performance score
Fluency	Smooth delivery — fewer hesitations = higher score
Coverage	How much of the source content you conveyed
Numbers	Accuracy of numbers, dates, and statistics

Error breakdown

- Hesitations detected (euh, um, ah, ...) — count and positions
- Omissions — content from the source you missed
- Number errors — figures you got wrong or skipped entirely
- Terminology issues — key terms not used in your interpretation

You also receive an AI feedback paragraph and, for Arabic, a pronunciation report showing word-by-word confidence scores.

Adaptive recommendations

After completing a session, the platform analyses your recent history and recommends a speech difficulty level, length, and domain suited to your current level. Go to Module E and click **Apply these settings** to use them next time.

7. Module E — Track Your Progress

Click **Progress** in the navigation bar to see:

- Latest session — your most recent scores at a glance
- Score trend — chart of your last 10 sessions showing improvement or decline
- Focus areas — skills declining or stable that you should prioritise
- Strengths — areas where you are consistently performing well
- Specific errors — your most frequent recurring mistakes
- Recommendations — difficulty and domain suggestions from the AI

Progress is tracked automatically every time you complete a full evaluation in Module D. You do not need to do anything extra.

8. Tips for Effective Practice

Module A — Speech generation

- Move to **Advanced** difficulty once you consistently score above 75 on **Intermediate**
- Turn on **Hesitations** to simulate real speaker conditions
- Use **Number density: High** if you struggle with figures — a common weak point
- Try the **UN Library** for authentic content on real UN topics

Module B — Study materials

- Study the key terms before listening — it reduces cognitive load during interpretation
- Read the thematic summary to build a mental map of the speech
- Download and review the glossary the evening before a practice session

Module C — Recording

- For **simultaneous**: start recording as soon as you hear the first sentence
- For **consecutive**: take the speech segment by segment if you prefer
- Speak clearly — the ASR model works better with clear articulation

Module D — Evaluation

- Always use **full evaluation** (with audio) — it gives you the complete picture
- Focus on one score at a time — if fluency is low, prioritise reducing hesitations
- Read the **AI feedback** paragraph carefully — it identifies patterns across sessions

General

- Practice every day for 20-30 minutes rather than once a week for 2 hours
- After each session, check **Focus areas** in **Module E** and choose your next topic accordingly
- The platform tracks everything automatically

9. Troubleshooting

"No Groq API key found" error

You have not saved your personal API key. Go to the gear icon (Settings), paste your key (gsk_...), test it, and save it. See Section 1.

"Invalid API key" when testing

- Make sure you copied the full key starting with gsk_
- Keys expire if deleted on console.groq.com — create a new one if needed
- Do not add spaces before or after the key

Speech generation is slow

Normal generation takes 5-15 seconds. If longer than 30 seconds, your Groq free-tier rate limit may have been reached. Wait 1 minute and try again.

Transcription is very slow (2+ minutes)

Your key may have reached the audio limit (2 000 seconds/day). The platform falls back to a local model automatically. Wait until the next day to use Groq Whisper again.

The recording button does not appear

Your browser needs microphone permission. Click the microphone icon in the address bar and allow access, then reload the page.

Scores seem too low

The platform is calibrated for conference interpreter training standards. A score of 60-70 is solid for a first attempt. Focus on consistency across sessions rather than a single high score.

"No matching UN document was found"

The UN Library did not find a document matching your topic. The speech is generated without grounding but includes factual accuracy guidelines. Try a more specific topic or a different language.

Quick Reference

Action	Where
Add / change your Groq API key	Gear icon (Settings) in the navigation bar
Generate a speech	Module A — Generate speech
Listen to the speech	Module B — Audio & materials
Download the glossary	Module B > Generate materials > Download glossary
Record your interpretation	Module C — Record & transcribe
Get your score and feedback	Module D — Evaluation
See your history and trends	Module E — Progress
Apply AI-recommended settings	Module E > Apply these settings